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RACE FOR CHICAGO MAYOR

Giannoulias dominates fundraising

Secretary of state raised \$12M, a sum larger than combined total for 7 other candidates

By **Jake Sheridan**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

In the crowded field of candidates committed to or flirting with a run for mayor of Chicago, Secretary of State Alexi Giannoulias again dominated fundraising to start the year.

Giannoulias raised more than \$12 million in the first quarter of 2026, according to state campaign

finance records, a sum far larger than the combined total for seven other likely candidates. The money, much of it from trade labor unions and some of Chicago’s wealthiest residents, would give Giannoulias an instant advantage if he enters the race.

He said in a statement that he was “honored” by those who “have encouraged me to run for other offices, including mayor of

Chicago.” He has not yet declared he is running, and his political team did not answer questions about the fundraising.

Five other candidates running or weighing campaigns as less progressive counterparts to Mayor Brandon Johnson raised more than \$100,000, evidence that February 2027’s election will likely again feature a crowded field.

Johnson, poised to become the race’s only progressive when he declares, raised more than \$176,000. That’s far below what former mayors Lori Lightfoot and Rahm

Emanuel brought in during the same quarter of their first terms, but Johnson’s political director, Christian Perry, said Johnson will have enough money to compete “if and when” he officially enters the race.

“We are doing what every good campaign should be doing for an incumbent, which is maintaining activity,” Perry said. “This will be a campaign that’s powered by working-class, blue-collar voters in the city of Chicago who want to see their interests represented on the fifth floor.”

At the same point in their first

terms, Lightfoot raised \$737,010, while Emanuel raised \$1.4 million. Lightfoot had \$1.7 million available, while Emanuel had \$74 million available, both far exceeding the \$813,125 Johnson has on hand in his campaign fund.

Downtown Ald. Bill Conway, a potential candidate, raised more than \$100,000 during the quarter, while entrepreneur Joe Holberg brought in \$285,171, \$250,000 of which came from a loan he made to his campaign.

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EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bracing for more flooding

Teo Quirola, left, of the Des Plaines Public Works Department, stacks a sandbag on a pallet for residents and business owners to pick up at the facility in Des Plaines on Thursday. Des Plaines was among the Chicago suburbs in Cook and Lake counties along the Des Plaines River experiencing flooding due to recent rainfall. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Israel and Lebanon OK 10-day truce

Mediators hoping the ceasefire can boost talks with the US and Iran

By **Kareem Chehayeb, Abby Sewell and Elena Becatoros**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

BEIRUT, Lebanon — President Donald Trump on Thursday announced that Israel and Lebanon had agreed to a 10-day ceasefire, a truce that could boost attempts to extend the ceasefire between Iran, the United States and Israel after weeks of devastating war.

Israel has not been fighting with Lebanon itself, but rather with the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group inside Lebanon. Hezbollah said in a statement that “any ceasefire must be comprehensive across all Lebanese territory and must not allow the Israeli enemy any freedom of movement.”

Barrages of gunshots rang out across Beirut as residents fired into the air just after midnight to celebrate the beginning of the truce.

Displaced families began moving toward southern Lebanon and Beirut’s southern suburbs, despite warnings by officials not to attempt to return to their homes until it became clear whether the ceasefire would hold.

Earlier, Israeli Prime Minister

See **TRUCE** on Page A9



Shoppers pass empty stores and closed kiosks inside the Ford City Mall in Chicago on Thursday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Ford City Mall heads toward closure

City has deal to shut it down, but tenants want more time

By **Brian J. Rogal**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago’s historic Ford City Mall, a shopping destination for generations of local residents ever since its 1965 opening in a renovated airplane factory, appears headed toward closure.

City officials reached an agreement this week with property owner Namdar Realty

Group to shut down the main mall after two years of fruitless attempts to repair a malfunctioning fire suppression system and stop frequent flooding, Assistant Corporation Counsel Greg Janes said Thursday at a hearing in Cook County court.

But shoppers and retail tenants at the massive indoor shopping mall on the Southwest Side got a seven-day reprieve after Judge Leonard Murray did not grant a request from city officials to quickly shutter the mostly vacant indoor shopping center due to

safety concerns.

Representatives for the massive property’s 16 remaining stores told the judge that the city’s emergency request, first put forward at an April 13 court hearing, left them blindsided.

“We just renewed the lease of a profitable store and it’s been operating since 1965,” said Allen Woolley, an attorney for JCPenney, the mall’s last large department store. “We would like to suggest this isn’t an emergency. An immediate vacating of this

See **MALL** on Page A5

State Senate passes e-bike, e-scooter safety bill

Responds to growing popularity of devices and concerns they raise

By **Jeremy Gornor**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — The Illinois Senate on Wednesday advanced a measure without opposition that would establish a regulatory framework for electric bicycles, motorcycles and scooters, responding to the growing popularity of the devices and the safety concerns they have raised.

The bill passed 54-0 and now moves to the House. It was initiated by Illinois Secretary of State Alexi Giannoulias’ office to keep pace with rapidly evolving technology around so-called e-bikes, e-motos and e-scooters, which have become increasingly common on streets and in bike lanes.

Their ubiquity has come with a cost. In September, a teenager was killed after the e-bike he was riding collided with a pickup truck in Chicago’s northwest suburbs. From 2019 to 2022, micromobility-related injuries and fatalities jumped 300% across the U.S, including in Illinois, the secretary of state’s office said.

Giannoulias said Wednesday that while the devices are convenient, affordable and environmentally friendly, “the technology has evolved faster than our laws.”

“Today, some of these devices travel well over 28 miles per hour. In some cases, exceeding 50 miles per hour. Yet, under current Illinois law, many remain undefined, inconsistently regulated, or not regulated at all,” he said at a statehouse news conference. “This creates confusion for riders, for families, for law enforcement, and for local governments.”

Under the legislation, riders of e-bikes and e-motos capable of traveling more than 28 mph would be required to have a driver’s license, title, registration and insurance. Riders of such devices, along with e-scooters, electric skateboards and electric unicycles, would be prohibited from exceeding 28 mph on roads, bike paths and sidewalks,

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INSIDE

‘May 1 is happening’ at CPS, Johnson says

Mayor signals his support for a day of protest as the CTU urges the district to cancel classes. CPS’ CEO has so far refused demands to do so. **Chicagoland, Page A4**

No playoffs this year, but maybe next?



Can the Blackhawks end their playoff drought next year? The GM calls the goal realistic — but would require a “major step.” **Sports**

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